JLPT N3

Kanji Workbook

75 Kanji in 8 Themed Lessons — Read, Write & Understand

Each lesson contains:
USAGE NOTES — Key nuances, common mistakes, and tricky readings for this group
REFERENCE TABLE — All kanji with ON (red) / kun (blue) readings, meaning, strokes, compounds
WRITING PRACTICE — Trace box + blank practice boxes per kanji
READING QUIZ — See the kanji, choose the correct reading
MEANING MATCH — Match kanji to English meanings
COMPOUND FILL-IN — Complete compound words using the lesson's kanji
FREE WRITING — Write original sentences using 4 chosen kanji
ANSWER KEY — All answers at the back

Lessons:
1. Emotions & Inner Life
2. Society & Relations
3. Nature & Environment
4. Thought & Communication
5. Work, Study & Achievement
6. Movement, Change & Process
7. Government, Law & Power
8. Appearance & Perception

How to Study N3 Kanji

The N3 Kanji Leap

N3 is where kanji study becomes significantly harder. Three key shifts:

1. ABSTRACT MEANINGS — N3 kanji describe emotions, social concepts, and processes, not just physical objects. You must understand meaning from context.
   e.g. 憧 (longing), 貫 (to persist), 漂 (to drift/waft) — no direct everyday equivalent.

2. MORE COMPOUNDS — At N3, a single kanji may appear in 10+ different compound words, each with a distinct meaning. Study compounds, not just individual characters.
   e.g. 訴: 訴える (appeal) / 訴訟 (lawsuit) / 起訴 (prosecution) / 告訴 (complaint)

3. SIMILAR KANJI CLUSTERS — N3 introduces many kanji that look alike or share components:
   揺・搖, 崩・朋, 貫・官, 浮・浸, 沈・汎 — pay attention to each radical.

Study approach for N3:
- Read one short news article (NHK Easy News) per day
- Write each new kanji 5 times minimum, with its reading and ONE compound
- Review 10 old kanji per study session (spaced repetition)
- Focus on recognising kanji in reading BEFORE perfecting writing

! N3 Danger Zones — Most Commonly Confused Kanji

努める (tsutomeru) = to strive vs 勤める (tsutomeru) = to work at — SAME reading!
述べる (noberu) = to state vs 伸べる (noberu) = to extend — SAME reading!
訴える (uttaeru) = to appeal vs 訴える (uttaeru) = to sue — SAME word, context tells you
誇る (hokoru) = to pride vs 誇張 (kochoo) = exaggeration — note ON reading
揺れる (yureru) = to shake (intr.) vs 揺する (yusuru) = to shake sth (trans.)
浮く (uku) = to float (intr.) vs 浮かぶ (ukabu) = to come to mind — subtly different
崩れる (kuzureru) = to crumble vs 崩す (kuzusu) = to break down sth — transitivity pair

Lesson 1: Emotions & Inner Life (感情・内面)

N3 emotion kanji go beyond simple happy/sad into nuanced states. These kanji appear in literary texts, news, and everyday conversation. Many form compound words that describe complex emotional experiences.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

怒 (okoru/ika-ru) has two kun readings: 怒る (okoru) = to get angry spontaneously; 怒り (ikari) = anger as a noun.
恐 and 怖 both relate to fear but differ: 恐怖 (kyoofu) = terror/dread; 怖い (kowai) = scary (everyday).
悔 (ku-iru) = to regret. 後悔 (kookai) = regret (after the fact). Don't confuse with 悲 (kanashii) = sad.
憎 (niku-mu) = to hate. Much stronger than 嫌い — used for deep hatred, not mere dislike.
恥 (haji/ha-zu) = shame. 恥ずかしい = embarrassing. 恥をかく = to be embarrassed.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
怒	ON: ド kun: おこる・いかる	anger	9	怒る (okoru) get angry・怒り (ikari) anger・激怒 (gekido) fury
恐	ON: キョウ kun: おそれる・おそろしい	fear/dread	10	恐怖 (kyoofu) terror・恐れ (osore) fear・恐ろしい (osoroshii) terrible
悔	ON: カイ kun: くいる・くやむ	regret	13	後悔 (kookai) regret・悔やむ (kuyamu) to regret・悔しい (kuyashii) frustrating
憎	ON: ゾウ kun: にくむ・にくい	hate	14	憎む (nikumu) hate・憎しみ (nikushimi) hatred・憎悪 (zooo) hatred/animosity
恥	ON: チ kun: はじ・はずかしい	shame	10	恥 (haji) shame・恥ずかしい (hazukashii) embarrassing・羞恥 (shuuchi) modesty
慌	ON: コウ kun: あわてる・あわただしい	panic/hurry	12	慌てる (awateru) panic・慌ただしい (awatadashii) hectic

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
励	ON: レイ kun: はげむ・はげます	encourage	7	励ます (hagemasu) encourage・励む (hagemu) strive・奨励 (shoorei) promotion
憧	ON: ドウ kun: あこがれる	yearn/admire	15	憧れ (akogare) longing・憧れる (akogareru) to admire/yearn for
諦	ON: テイ kun: あきらめる	give up	16	諦める (akirameru) give up・諦め (akirame) resignation
慕	ON: ボ kun: したう	adore/long for	14	慕う (shitau) adore・思慕 (shibo) longing

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

怒 ド | anger | 9 strokes

Compounds: 怒る (okoru) get angry・怒り (ikari) anger・激怒 (gekido) fury

怒				

恐 キョウ | fear/dread | 10 strokes

Compounds: 恐怖 (kyoofu) terror・恐れ (osore) fear・恐ろしい (osoroshii) terrible

恐				

悔 カイ | regret | 13 strokes

Compounds: 後悔 (kookai) regret・悔やむ (kuyamu) to regret・悔しい (kuyashii) frustrating

悔				

憎 ゾウ | hate | 14 strokes

Compounds: 憎む (nikumu) hate・憎しみ (nikushimi) hatred・憎悪 (zooo) hatred/animosity

憎				

恥 チ | shame | 10 strokes

Compounds: 恥 (haji) shame・恥ずかしい (hazukashii) embarrassing・羞恥 (shuuchi) modesty

恥				

慌 コウ | panic/hurry | 12 strokes

Compounds: 慌てる (awateru) panic・慌ただしい (awatadashii) hectic

慌				

励 レイ | encourage | 7 strokes

Compounds: 励ます (hagemasu) encourage・励む (hagemu) strive・奨励 (shoorei) promotion

励				

憧 ドウ | yearn/admire | 15 strokes

Compounds: 憧れ (akogare) longing・憧れる (akogareru) to admire/yearn for

憧				

諦 テイ | give up | 16 strokes

Compounds: 諦める (akirameru) give up・諦め (akirame) resignation

諦				

慕 ボ | adore/long for | 14 strokes

Compounds: 慕う (shitau) adore・思慕 (shibo) longing

慕				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	怒	A) かきく B) さしす C) ド D) おこる *My answer:* _____
2.	恐	A) おそれる B) さしす C) キョウ D) かきく *My answer:* _____
3.	悔	A) かきく B) カイ C) さしす D) くいる *My answer:* _____
4.	憎	A) さしす B) ゾウ C) にくむ D) かきく *My answer:* _____
5.	恥	A) かきく B) さしす C) チ D) はじ *My answer:* _____
6.	慌	A) かきく B) さしす C) コウ D) あわてる *My answer:* _____
7.	励	A) はげむ B) さしす C) かきく D) レイ *My answer:* _____
8.	憧	A) かきく B) あこがれる C) ドウ D) さしす *My answer:* _____

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	怒	____	A	give up
2.	恐	____	B	fear/dread
3.	悔	____	C	anger

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
4.	憎	_____	D	hate
5.	恥	_____	E	regret
6.	慌	_____	F	adore/long for
7.	励	_____	G	yearn/admire
8.	憧	_____	H	shame
9.	諦	_____	I	panic/hurry
10.	慕	_____	J	encourage

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「怒」を使った言葉: ___る *Compound using 怒: 怒る (get angry)*	
2.	「恐」を使った言葉: ___怖 *Compound using 恐: 恐怖 (terror)*	
3.	「悔」を使った言葉: ___後 *Compound using 悔: 後悔 (regret)*	
4.	「憎」を使った言葉: ___む *Compound using 憎: 憎む (hate)*	
5.	「恥」を使った言葉: ___ *Compound using 恥: 恥 (shame)*	
6.	「慌」を使った言葉: ___てる *Compound using 慌: 慌てる (panic)*	
7.	「励」を使った言葉: ___ます *Compound using 励: 励ます (encourage)*	
8.	「憧」を使った言葉: ___れ *Compound using 憧: 憧れ (longing)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 2: Society & Human Relations (社会・人間関係)

Society and relationship kanji are core to N3 reading comprehension. They appear constantly in news articles, business writing, and everyday conversation. Pay attention to which form complex compound words.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

争 (arasoi) = conflict/dispute. 戦争 (sensoo) = war. 競争 (kyoosoo) = competition. Note the different nuances.
批 (hi) only appears in compounds: 批判 (hihan) criticism, 批評 (hihyoo) review, 批准 (hijun) ratification.
賛 and 反: 賛成 (sansei) = agreement; 反対 (hantai) = opposition. These are tested together at N3.
豊 (yutaka/HOO) = rich/abundant. 豊か (yutaka) = wealthy/abundant (na-adjective).
貧 (mazushii/HIN) = poor. 貧しい (mazushii) = poor (i-adjective). Opposite of 豊.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
争	ON: ソウ kun: あらそう	dispute/ compete	6	戦争 (sensoo) war・競争 (kyoosoo) competition・争い (arasoi) conflict
批	ON: ヒ kun: —	criticise	7	批判 (hihan) criticism・批評 (hihyoo) review/critique・批准 (hijun) ratification
賛	ON: サン kun: —	agree/ praise	15	賛成 (sansei) agreement・賛否 (sanpi) pros & cons・賛同 (sandoo) approval
豊	ON: ホウ kun: ゆたか	abundant/ rich	13	豊か (yutaka) wealthy・豊富 (hoofu) abundant・豊作 (hoosaku) good harvest
貧	ON: ヒン kun: まずしい	poor	11	貧しい (mazushii) poor・貧困 (hinkon) poverty・貧富 (hinpu) rich & poor
犯	ON: ハン kun: おかす	crime/ offend	5	犯罪 (hanzai) crime・犯人 (hannin) criminal・犯す (okasu) to commit
罰	ON: バツ・ハツ kun: ばっする	punishment	9	罰 (batsu) punishment・罰金 (bakkin) fine・体罰 (taibatsu) corporal punishment

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
誠	ON: セイ kun: まこと	sincerity	13	誠実 (seijitsu) sincere・誠意 (seii) sincerity・誠に (makoto ni) truly
謙	ON: ケン kun: —	humble	17	謙虚 (kenkyo) humility・謙遜 (kenson) modesty・謙譲語 (kenjoogoo) humble speech
誇	ON: コ kun: ほこる	pride/boast	13	誇る (hokoru) to pride・誇り (hokori) pride・誇張 (kochoo) exaggeration

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

争 ソウ | dispute/compete | 6 strokes

Compounds: 戦争 (sensoo) war・競争 (kyoosoo) competition・争い (arasoi) conflict

争				

批 ヒ | criticise | 7 strokes

Compounds: 批判 (hihan) criticism・批評 (hihyoo) review/critique・批准 (hijun) ratification

批				

賛 サン | agree/praise | 15 strokes

Compounds: 賛成 (sansei) agreement・賛否 (sanpi) pros & cons・賛同 (sandoo) approval

賛				

豊 ホウ | abundant/rich | 13 strokes

Compounds: 豊か (yutaka) wealthy・豊富 (hoofu) abundant・豊作 (hoosaku) good harvest

豊				

貧 ヒン | poor | 11 strokes

Compounds: 貧しい (mazushii) poor・貧困 (hinkon) poverty・貧富 (hinpu) rich & poor

貧				

犯 ハン | crime/offend | 5 strokes

Compounds: 犯罪 (hanzai) crime・犯人 (hannin) criminal・犯す (okasu) to commit

犯				

罰 バツ・ハツ | punishment | 9 strokes

Compounds: 罰 (batsu) punishment・罰金 (bakkin) fine・体罰 (taibatsu) corporal punishment

罰				

誠 セイ | sincerity | 13 strokes

Compounds: 誠実 (seijitsu) sincere・誠意 (seii) sincerity・誠に (makoto ni) truly

誠				

謙 ケン | humble | 17 strokes

Compounds: 謙虚 (kenkyo) humility・謙遜 (kenson) modesty・謙譲語 (kenjoogoo) humble speech

謙				

誇 コ | pride/boast | 13 strokes

Compounds: 誇る (hokoru) to pride・誇り (hokori) pride・誇張 (kochoo) exaggeration

誇				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	争	A) あらそう B) さしす C) ソウ D) かきく *My answer: _____*
2.	批	A) かきく B) ヒ C) さしす D) — *My answer: _____*
3.	賛	A) かきく B) — C) さしす D) サン *My answer: _____*
4.	豊	A) ホウ B) ゆたか C) さしす D) かきく *My answer: _____*
5.	貧	A) さしす B) かきく C) まずしい D) ヒン *My answer: _____*
6.	犯	A) かきく B) おかす C) さしす D) ハン *My answer: _____*
7.	罰	A) バツ B) ばっする C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
8.	誠	A) かきく B) さしす C) まこと D) セイ *My answer: _____*

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	争	____	**A**	agree/praise
2.	批	____	**B**	crime/offend
3.	賛	____	**C**	humble
4.	豊	____	**D**	criticise
5.	貧	____	**E**	pride/boast

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
6.	犯	____	F	abundant/rich
7.	罰	____	G	dispute/compete
8.	誠	____	H	sincerity
9.	謙	____	I	poor
10.	誇	____	J	punishment

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「争」を使った言葉: ___戦 *Compound using 争: 戦争 (war)*	
2.	「批」を使った言葉: ___判 *Compound using 批: 批判 (criticism)*	
3.	「賛」を使った言葉: ___成 *Compound using 賛: 賛成 (agreement)*	
4.	「豊」を使った言葉: ___か *Compound using 豊: 豊か (wealthy)*	
5.	「貧」を使った言葉: ___しい *Compound using 貧: 貧しい (poor)*	
6.	「犯」を使った言葉: ___罪 *Compound using 犯: 犯罪 (crime)*	
7.	「罰」を使った言葉: ___ *Compound using 罰: 罰 (punishment)*	
8.	「誠」を使った言葉: ___実 *Compound using 誠: 誠実 (sincere)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.

Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 3: Nature & Environment (自然・環境)

N3 nature kanji extend beyond basic weather and geography into environmental and scientific vocabulary. These appear in news articles about climate, disasters, and ecology.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

災 (waza-wai/SAI) = disaster. 自然災害 (shizen saigai) = natural disaster — a key compound at N3.
燃 (mo-eru/NEN) = burn. 燃料 (nenryoo) = fuel. 燃える is intransitive; 燃やす is transitive (to burn something).
汚 (yogosu/O) = dirty/pollute. 汚染 (osen) = pollution. 汚す (yogosu) = to dirty (transitive).
乾 (kawa-ku/KAN) = dry. 乾燥 (kansoo) = dryness. Intrans: 乾く / Trans: 乾かす.
枯 (ka-reru/KO) = wither. Refers to plants dying. Don't use for people — use 亡くなる.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
災	ON: サイ kun: わざわい	disaster	7	災害 (saigai) disaster・火災 (kasai) fire・自然災害 (shizen saigai) natural disaster
燃	ON: ネン kun: もえる・もやす	burn	16	燃える (moeru) burn・燃料 (nenryoo) fuel・燃焼 (nenshoo) combustion
汚	ON: オ kun: よごす・きたない	dirty/pollute	6	汚染 (osen) pollution・汚す (yogosu) dirty・汚れ (yogore) dirt/stain
乾	ON: カン kun: かわく・かわかす	dry	11	乾燥 (kansoo) dryness・乾く (kawaku) dry out・乾かす (kawakasu) dry sth
枯	ON: コ kun: かれる・からす	wither	9	枯れる (kareru) wither・枯れ木 (karekii) dead tree・枯渇 (kokatsu) depletion
浸	ON: シン kun: ひたす・ひたる	soak/ immerse	10	浸水 (shinsui) flooding・浸る (hitaru) to soak・浸透 (shintoo) permeation
霧	ON: ム kun: きり	fog/mist	19	霧 (kiri) fog・霧雨 (kirisame) drizzle・濃霧 (noumu) thick fog

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
稲	ON: トウ kun: いね	rice plant	14	稲 (ine) rice plant・稲作 (inasaku) rice cultivation・稲妻 (inazuma) lightning
耕	ON: コウ kun: たがやす	cultivate/ plough	10	耕す (tagayasu) cultivate・農耕 (nookoo) agriculture・耕地 (koochi) arable land
析	ON: セキ kun: —	divide/ analyse	8	分析 (bunseki) analysis・解析 (kaiseki) analysis・析出 (sekishutsu) precipitation

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

災 サイ | disaster | 7 strokes

Compounds: 災害 (saigai) disaster・火災 (kasai) fire・自然災害 (shizen saigai) natural disaster

災				

燃 ネン | burn | 16 strokes

Compounds: 燃える (moeru) burn・燃料 (nenryoo) fuel・燃焼 (nenshoo) combustion

燃				

汚 オ | dirty/pollute | 6 strokes

Compounds: 汚染 (osen) pollution・汚す (yogosu) dirty・汚れ (yogore) dirt/stain

汚				

乾 カン | dry | 11 strokes

Compounds: 乾燥 (kansoo) dryness・乾く (kawaku) dry out・乾かす (kawakasu) dry sth

乾				

枯 コ | wither | 9 strokes

Compounds: 枯れる (kareru) wither・枯れ木 (karekii) dead tree・枯渇 (kokatsu) depletion

枯				

浸 シン | soak/immerse | 10 strokes

Compounds: 浸水 (shinsui) flooding・浸る (hitaru) to soak・浸透 (shintoo) permeation

浸				

霧 ム | fog/mist | 19 strokes

Compounds: 霧 (kiri) fog・霧雨 (kirisame) drizzle・濃霧 (noumu) thick fog

霧				

稲 トウ | rice plant | 14 strokes

Compounds: 稲 (ine) rice plant・稲作 (inasaku) rice cultivation・稲妻 (inazuma) lightning

稲				

耕 コウ | cultivate/plough | 10 strokes

Compounds: 耕す (tagayasu) cultivate・農耕 (nookoo) agriculture・耕地 (koochi) arable land

耕				

析 セキ | divide/analyse | 8 strokes

Compounds: 分析 (bunseki) analysis・解析 (kaiseki) analysis・析出 (sekishutsu) precipitation

析				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	災	A) サイ B) わざわい C) さしす D) かきく *My answer:* _____
2.	燃	A) ネン B) もえる C) かきく D) さしす *My answer:* _____
3.	汚	A) よごす B) オ C) かきく D) さしす *My answer:* _____
4.	乾	A) かきく B) かわく C) さしす D) カン *My answer:* _____
5.	枯	A) かれる B) さしす C) コ D) かきく *My answer:* _____
6.	浸	A) かきく B) さしす C) ひたす D) シン *My answer:* _____
7.	霧	A) さしす B) かきく C) きり D) ム *My answer:* _____
8.	稲	A) トウ B) いね C) さしす D) かきく *My answer:* _____

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	災	____	**A**	wither
2.	燃	____	**B**	cultivate/plough
3.	汚	____	**C**	rice plant
4.	乾	____	**D**	disaster

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
5.	枯	____	E	burn
6.	浸	____	F	dry
7.	霧	____	G	dirty/pollute
8.	稲	____	H	fog/mist
9.	耕	____	I	divide/analyse
10.	析	____	J	soak/immerse

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「災」を使った言葉: ___害 *Compound using 災: 災害 (disaster)*	
2.	「燃」を使った言葉: ___える *Compound using 燃: 燃える (burn)*	
3.	「汚」を使った言葉: ___染 *Compound using 汚: 汚染 (pollution)*	
4.	「乾」を使った言葉: ___燥 *Compound using 乾: 乾燥 (dryness)*	
5.	「枯」を使った言葉: ___れる *Compound using 枯: 枯れる (wither)*	
6.	「浸」を使った言葉: ___水 *Compound using 浸: 浸水 (flooding)*	
7.	「霧」を使った言葉: ___ *Compound using 霧: 霧 (fog)*	
8.	「稲」を使った言葉: ___ *Compound using 稲: 稲 (rice plant)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 4: Thought, Speech & Communication (思考・言語・伝達)

Communication and thought kanji are among the most tested at N3. They form a huge range of verbs and nouns related to expressing, interpreting, and processing information.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

述 (no-beru/JUTSU) = to state. 述べる is more formal than 言う — used in essays and formal speech.
訴 (utta-eru/SO) = to appeal/sue. 訴える has three meanings: to sue (legal), to appeal to emotions, to complain.
欺 (azamu-ku/GI) = to deceive. Serious word — used in legal/news contexts, not casual speech.
宣 (SEN) always appears in compounds: 宣言 (sengen) declaration, 宣伝 (senden) advertising/propaganda.
諭 (sato-su/YU) = to admonish. This is the same kanji as 教諭 (kyooyu = teacher, formal term).

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
述	ON: ジュツ kun: のべる	state/ mention	8	述べる (noberu) state・記述 (kijutsu) description・陳述 (chinjutsu) statement
訴	ON: ソ kun: うったえる	appeal/sue	12	訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue・訴訟 (sooshoo) lawsuit・起訴 (kiso) prosecution
宣	ON: セン kun: —	proclaim	9	宣言 (sengen) declaration・宣伝 (senden) advertising・宣告 (senkoku) verdict
訳	ON: ヤク kun: わけ	translate/ reason	11	翻訳 (hon'yaku) translation・言い訳 (iiwake) excuse・訳す (yaku su) translate
諭	ON: ユ kun: さとす	admonish/ teach	16	諭す (satosu) admonish・教諭 (kyooyu) teacher (formal)・諭旨 (yushi) admonition
唱	ON: ショウ kun: となえる	chant/ advocate	11	唱える (tonaeru) chant/advocate・合唱 (gasshoo) chorus・提唱 (teishoo) advocacy
欺	ON: ギ kun: あざむく	deceive	12	欺く (azamuku) deceive・詐欺 (sagi) fraud・欺瞞 (giman) deception

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
弁	ON: ベン kun: —	speech/ valve/petal	5	弁護士 (bengoshi) lawyer・弁当 (bentoo) lunchbox・弁済 (bensai) repayment
論	ON: ロン kun: —	argue/ theory	15	議論 (giron) debate・論文 (ronbun) thesis・結論 (ketsuron) conclusion

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

述 ジュツ | state/mention | 8 strokes

Compounds: 述べる (noberu) state・記述 (kijutsu) description・陳述 (chinjutsu) statement

述				

訴 ソ | appeal/sue | 12 strokes

Compounds: 訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue・訴訟 (sooshoo) lawsuit・起訴 (kiso) prosecution

訴				

宣 セン | proclaim | 9 strokes

Compounds: 宣言 (sengen) declaration・宣伝 (senden) advertising・宣告 (senkoku) verdict

宣				

訳 ヤク | translate/reason | 11 strokes

Compounds: 翻訳 (hon'yaku) translation・言い訳 (iiwake) excuse・訳す (yaku su) translate

訳				

諭 ユ | admonish/teach | 16 strokes

Compounds: 諭す (satosu) admonish・教諭 (kyooyu) teacher (formal)・諭旨 (yushi) admonition

諭				

唱 ショウ | chant/advocate | 11 strokes

Compounds: 唱える (tonaeru) chant/advocate・合唱 (gasshoo) chorus・提唱 (teishoo) advocacy

唱				

欺 ギ | deceive | 12 strokes

Compounds: 欺く (azamuku) deceive・詐欺 (sagi) fraud・欺瞞 (giman) deception

欺				

弁 ベン | speech/valve/petal | 5 strokes

Compounds: 弁護士 (bengoshi) lawyer・弁当 (bentoo) lunchbox・弁済 (bensai) repayment

弁				

論 ロン | argue/theory | 15 strokes

Compounds: 議論 (giron) debate・論文 (ronbun) thesis・結論 (ketsuron) conclusion

論				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	述	A) かきく B) さしす C) のべる D) ジュツ *My answer: _____*
2.	訴	A) ソ B) うったえる C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
3.	宣	A) さしす B) かきく C) — D) セン *My answer: _____*

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
4.	訳	A) さしす B) ヤク C) わけ D) かきく *My answer: _____*
5.	諭	A) さとす B) かきく C) ユ D) さしす *My answer: _____*
6.	唱	A) となえる B) ショウ C) さしす D) かきく *My answer: _____*
7.	欺	A) ギ B) さしす C) あざむく D) かきく *My answer: _____*
8.	弁	A) ベン B) さしす C) — D) かきく *My answer: _____*

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	述	____	A	chant/advocate
2.	訴	____	B	deceive
3.	宣	____	C	proclaim
4.	訳	____	D	translate/reason
5.	諭	____	E	admonish/teach
6.	唱	____	F	argue/theory
7.	欺	____	G	appeal/sue
8.	弁	____	H	speech/valve/petal
9.	論	____	I	state/mention

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「述」を使った言葉: ___べる *Compound using 述: 述べる (state)*	
2.	「訴」を使った言葉: ___える *Compound using 訴: 訴える (appeal/sue)*	
3.	「宣」を使った言葉: ___言 *Compound using 宣: 宣言 (declaration)*	
4.	「訳」を使った言葉: ___翻 *Compound using 訳: 翻訳 (translation)*	
5.	「諭」を使った言葉: ___す *Compound using 諭: 諭す (admonish)*	
6.	「唱」を使った言葉: ___える *Compound using 唱: 唱える (chant/advocate)*	
7.	「欺」を使った言葉: ___く *Compound using 欺: 欺く (deceive)*	
8.	「弁」を使った言葉: ___護士 *Compound using 弁: 弁護士 (lawyer)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 5: Work, Study & Achievement (仕事・学習・達成)

Achievement and work kanji are essential for N3, as they appear in job-hunting documents, academic contexts, and news about business and education.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

努 (tsuto-meru/DO) = to make an effort. 努力 (doryoku) = effort. Don't confuse with 働く (hataraku) = to work.
勤 (tsuto-meru/KIN) = to work/be employed. 勤務 (kinmu) = service/duty. Same reading as 努める but different kanji!
績 (SEKI) = achievement/result. Always appears in compounds: 成績, 業績, 実績, 功績.
奨 (SHOO) = encourage/award. 奨学金 (shoogakukin) = scholarship — extremely important N3 vocabulary.
雇 (yato-u/KO) = to employ/hire. 雇用 (koyoo) = employment. 解雇 (kaiko) = dismissal/firing.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
努	ON: ド kun: つとめる	endeavour/ strive	7	努力 (doryoku) effort・努める (tsutomeru) strive・努力家 (doryokuka) hard worker
勤	ON: キン kun: つとめる	work/serve	12	勤務 (kinmu) duty・勤める (tsutomeru) work at・出勤 (shukkin) going to work
績	ON: セキ kun: —	achieveme nt	17	成績 (seiseki) grades・業績 (gyooseki) achievement・実績 (jisseki) track record
奨	ON: ショウ kun: —	encourage/ award	13	奨学金 (shoogakukin) scholarship・奨励 (shoorei) encouragement・推奨 (suishoo) recommendation
雇	ON: コ kun: やとう	hire/employ	12	雇用 (koyoo) employment・雇う (yatou) hire・解雇 (kaiko) dismissal
昇	ON: ショウ kun: のぼる	rise/ascend	8	昇進 (shooshin) promotion・上昇 (jooshoo) rise・昇格 (shookaku) upgrading
免	ON: メン kun: まぬかれる	exempt/ license	8	免許 (menkyo) license・免除 (menjo) exemption・免責 (menseki) exemption from liability

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
携	ON: ケイ kun: たずさわる・たずさえる	involve/ carry	13	携帯 (keitai) mobile phone/carrying・携わる (tazusawaru) be involved in
貢	ON: コウ・ク kun: みつぎ	tribute/ contribute	10	貢献 (kooken) contribution・年貢 (nengu) land tax

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

努 ド | endeavour/strive | 7 strokes

Compounds: 努力 (doryoku) effort・努める (tsutomeru) strive・努力家 (doryokuka) hard worker

努				

勤 キン | work/serve | 12 strokes

Compounds: 勤務 (kinmu) duty・勤める (tsutomeru) work at・出勤 (shukkin) going to work

勤				

績 セキ | achievement | 17 strokes

Compounds: 成績 (seiseki) grades・業績 (gyooseki) achievement・実績 (jisseki) track record

績				

奨 ショウ | encourage/award | 13 strokes

Compounds: 奨学金 (shoogakukin) scholarship・奨励 (shoorei) encouragement・推奨 (suishoo) recommendation

奨				

雇 コ | hire/employ | 12 strokes

Compounds: 雇用 (koyoo) employment・雇う (yatou) hire・解雇 (kaiko) dismissal

雇				

昇 ショウ | rise/ascend | 8 strokes

Compounds: 昇進 (shooshin) promotion・上昇 (jooshoo) rise・昇格 (shookaku) upgrading

昇				

免 メン | exempt/license | 8 strokes

Compounds: 免許 (menkyo) license・免除 (menjo) exemption・免責 (menseki) exemption from liability

免				

携 ケイ | involve/carry | 13 strokes

Compounds: 携帯 (keitai) mobile phone/carrying・携わる (tazusawaru) be involved in

携				

貢 コウ・ク | tribute/contribute | 10 strokes

Compounds: 貢献 (kooken) contribution・年貢 (nengu) land tax

貢				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	努	A) さしす B) ド C) つとめる D) かきく *My answer: _____*
2.	勤	A) かきく B) つとめる C) キン D) さしす *My answer: _____*
3.	績	A) セキ B) — C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
4.	奨	A) ショウ B) — C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
5.	雇	A) コ B) やとう C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
6.	昇	A) ショウ B) のぼる C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
7.	免	A) メン B) まぬかれる C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
8.	携	A) ケイ B) かきく C) さしす D) たずさわる *My answer: _____*

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	努	____	A	rise/ascend
2.	勤	____	B	endeavour/strive
3.	績	____	C	work/serve
4.	奨	____	D	exempt/license
5.	雇	____	E	tribute/contribute
6.	昇	____	F	achievement
7.	免	____	G	involve/carry
8.	携	____	H	hire/employ
9.	貢	____	I	encourage/award

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「努」を使った言葉: ___力 *Compound using 努: 努力 (effort)*	
2.	「勤」を使った言葉: ___務 *Compound using 勤: 勤務 (duty)*	
3.	「績」を使った言葉: ___成 *Compound using 績: 成績 (grades)*	
4.	「奨」を使った言葉: ___学金 *Compound using 奨: 奨学金 (scholarship)*	
5.	「雇」を使った言葉: ___用 *Compound using 雇: 雇用 (employment)*	
6.	「昇」を使った言葉: ___進 *Compound using 昇: 昇進 (promotion)*	
7.	「免」を使った言葉: ___許 *Compound using 免: 免許 (license)*	
8.	「携」を使った言葉: ___帯 *Compound using 携: 携帯 (mobile phone/carrying)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 6: Movement, Change & Process (動き・変化・過程)

Movement and process kanji describe how things change, move, and transform. At N3, these appear in more complex sentence structures involving causative, passive, and compound verbs.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

揺 (yureru/YOO) = to shake/sway. 揺れる (intransitive) vs 揺する (transitive). Both important at N3.
崩 (kuzureru/HOO) = to crumble. 崩壊 (hookai) = collapse — appears in news about buildings, economies.
貫 (tsura-nuku/KAN) = to penetrate/stick to. 貫く = to follow through; 一貫 (ikkan) = consistent.
浮 (u-ku/FU) = to float/surface. 浮かぶ = to float/come to mind. Also: 浮気 (uwaki) = infidelity.
沈 (shizu-mu/CHIN) = to sink. Opposite of 浮かぶ. 沈む = to sink/feel depressed.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
揺	ON: ヨウ kun: ゆれる・ゆする	shake/ sway	12	揺れる (yureru) shake・動揺 (dooyoo) agitation・揺さぶる (yusaburu) to shake
崩	ON: ホウ kun: くずれる・くずす	collapse	11	崩壊 (hookai) collapse・崩れる (kuzureru) crumble・土砂崩れ (doshakuzure) landslide
貫	ON: カン kun: つらぬく	pierce/ persist	11	貫く (tsuranuku) pierce/persist・一貫 (ikkan) consistency・貫通 (kantsuu) penetration
浮	ON: フ kun: うく・うかぶ	float/ surface	10	浮かぶ (ukabu) float・浮力 (furyoku) buoyancy・浮気 (uwaki) infidelity
沈	ON: チン kun: しずむ・しずめる	sink/ depress	7	沈む (shizumu) sink・沈黙 (chinmoku) silence・撃沈 (gekichin) sinking (ship)
継	ON: ケイ kun: つぐ	inherit/ succeed	13	継続 (keizoku) continuation・引き継ぐ (hikitsugu) succeed・後継 (kookei) successor

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
超	ON: チョウ kun: こえる・こす	exceed/super	12	超える (koeru) exceed・超過 (chooka) excess・超自然 (chooshizen) supernatural
跳	ON: チョウ kun: はねる・とぶ	jump/leap	13	跳ぶ (tobu) jump・跳ね上がる (hane agaru) soar・三段跳び (sandantoobi) triple jump
潜	ON: セン kun: もぐる・ひそむ	dive/lurk	15	潜水 (sensui) diving・潜在 (senzai) latent・潜む (hissomu) to lurk

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

揺 ヨウ | shake/sway | 12 strokes

Compounds: 揺れる (yureru) shake・動揺 (dooyoo) agitation・揺さぶる (yusaburu) to shake

揺				

崩 ホウ | collapse | 11 strokes

Compounds: 崩壊 (hookai) collapse・崩れる (kuzureru) crumble・土砂崩れ (doshakuzure) landslide

崩				

貫 カン | pierce/persist | 11 strokes

Compounds: 貫く (tsuranuku) pierce/persist・一貫 (ikkan) consistency・貫通 (kantsuu) penetration

貫				

浮 フ | float/surface | 10 strokes

Compounds: 浮かぶ (ukabu) float・浮力 (furyoku) buoyancy・浮気 (uwaki) infidelity

浮				

沈 チン | sink/depress | 7 strokes

Compounds: 沈む (shizumu) sink・沈黙 (chinmoku) silence・撃沈 (gekichin) sinking (ship)

沈				

継 ケイ | inherit/succeed | 13 strokes

Compounds: 継続 (keizoku) continuation・引き継ぐ (hikitsugu) succeed・後継 (kookei) successor

継				

超 チョウ | exceed/super | 12 strokes

Compounds: 超える (koeru) exceed・超過 (chooka) excess・超自然 (chooshizen) supernatural

超				

跳 チョウ | jump/leap | 13 strokes

Compounds: 跳ぶ (tobu) jump・跳ね上がる (hane agaru) soar・三段跳び (sandantoobi) triple jump

跳				

潜 セン | dive/lurk | 15 strokes

Compounds: 潜水 (sensui) diving・潜在 (senzai) latent・潜む (hissomu) to lurk

潜				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	揺	A) かきく B) さしす C) ヨウ D) ゆれる *My answer:* _____
2.	崩	A) さしす B) かきく C) くずれる D) ホウ *My answer:* _____
3.	貫	A) さしす B) カン C) つらぬく D) かきく *My answer:* _____
4.	浮	A) かきく B) うく C) さしす D) フ *My answer:* _____
5.	沈	A) しずむ B) かきく C) さしす D) チン *My answer:* _____
6.	継	A) さしす B) かきく C) つぐ D) ケイ *My answer:* _____
7.	超	A) チョウ B) こえる C) かきく D) さしす *My answer:* _____
8.	跳	A) さしす B) かきく C) はねる D) チョウ *My answer:* _____

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	揺	____	**A**	jump/leap
2.	崩	____	**B**	inherit/succeed
3.	貫	____	**C**	dive/lurk
4.	浮	____	**D**	collapse
5.	沈	____	**E**	pierce/persist
6.	継	____	**F**	exceed/super

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
7.	超	_____	G	sink/depress
8.	跳	_____	H	shake/sway
9.	潜	_____	I	float/surface

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「揺」を使った言葉: ___れる *Compound using 揺: 揺れる (shake)*	
2.	「崩」を使った言葉: ___壊 *Compound using 崩: 崩壊 (collapse)*	
3.	「貫」を使った言葉: ___く *Compound using 貫: 貫く (pierce/persist)*	
4.	「浮」を使った言葉: ___かぶ *Compound using 浮: 浮かぶ (float)*	
5.	「沈」を使った言葉: ___む *Compound using 沈: 沈む (sink)*	
6.	「継」を使った言葉: ___続 *Compound using 継: 継続 (continuation)*	
7.	「超」を使った言葉: ___える *Compound using 超: 超える (exceed)*	
8.	「跳」を使った言葉: ___ぶ *Compound using 跳: 跳ぶ (jump)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 7: Government, Law & Power (政治・法律・権力)

Government and law kanji are essential for reading Japanese news and formal documents. These kanji appear in political news, legal texts, and discussions of social systems.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

権 (KEN) = right/authority. 権利 (kenri) = rights; 権力 (kenryoku) = power. Always in compounds.
律 (RITSU) = law/regulation. 法律 (hooritsu) = law. Different from 則 (rule) and 規 (standard).
統 (TOSHI/too-beru) = govern/unite. 統一 (tooitsu) = unification; 統計 (tookei) = statistics.
廃 (suta-reru/HAI) = abolish/廃. 廃止 (haishi) = abolition; 廃棄 (haiki) = disposal/discard.
署 (SHO) = office/sign. 警察署 (keisatsusho) = police station; 署名 (shomei) = signature.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
権	ON: ケン・ゴン kun: —	right/ authority	15	権利 (kenri) rights・権力 (kenryoku) power・人権 (jinken) human rights
律	ON: リツ・リチ kun: —	law/ regulation	9	法律 (hooritsu) law・規律 (kiritsu) discipline・旋律 (senritsu) melody
統	ON: トウ kun: すべる	govern/ unify	12	統一 (tooitsu) unification・統計 (tookei) statistics・大統領 (daitoooryoo) president
廃	ON: ハイ kun: すたれる	abolish/廃	12	廃止 (haishi) abolition・廃棄 (haiki) disposal・廃墟 (haikyo) ruins
署	ON: ショ kun: —	office/sign	13	警察署 (keisatsusho) police station・署名 (shomei) signature・消防署 (shooboosho) fire station
訴	ON: ソ kun: うったえる	sue/appeal	12	訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue・訴訟 (sooshoo) lawsuit・告訴 (kooso) complaint
議	ON: ギ kun: —	deliberate	20	議会 (gikai) parliament・議論 (giron) debate・会議 (kaigi) meeting
策	ON: サク kun: —	plan/ scheme	12	政策 (seisaku) policy・対策 (taisaku) countermeasure・策略 (sakuryaku) strategy

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
棄	ON: キ kun: すてる	abandon/ discard	13	廃棄 (haiki) discard・放棄 (hooki) abandonment・棄権 (kiken) abstention

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

権 ケン・ゴン | right/authority | 15 strokes

Compounds: 権利 (kenri) rights・権力 (kenryoku) power・人権 (jinken) human rights

権				

律 リツ・リチ | law/regulation | 9 strokes

Compounds: 法律 (hooritsu) law・規律 (kiritsu) discipline・旋律 (senritsu) melody

律				

統 トウ | govern/unify | 12 strokes

Compounds: 統一 (tooitsu) unification・統計 (tookei) statistics・大統領 (daitoooryoo) president

統				

廃 ハイ | abolish/廃 | 12 strokes

Compounds: 廃止 (haishi) abolition・廃棄 (haiki) disposal・廃墟 (haikyo) ruins

廃				

署 ショ | office/sign | 13 strokes

Compounds: 警察署 (keisatsusho) police station・署名 (shomei) signature・消防署 (shooboosho) fire station

署				

訴 ソ | sue/appeal | 12 strokes

Compounds: 訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue・訴訟 (sooshoo) lawsuit・告訴 (kooso) complaint

訴				

議 ギ | deliberate | 20 strokes

Compounds: 議会 (gikai) parliament・議論 (giron) debate・会議 (kaigi) meeting

議				

策 サク | plan/scheme | 12 strokes

Compounds: 政策 (seisaku) policy・対策 (taisaku) countermeasure・策略 (sakuryaku) strategy

策				

棄 キ | abandon/discard | 13 strokes

Compounds: 廃棄 (haiki) discard・放棄 (hooki) abandonment・棄権 (kiken) abstention

棄				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	権	A) かきく B) さしす C) — D) ケン *My answer: _____*
2.	律	A) さしす B) かきく C) — D) リツ *My answer: _____*
3.	統	A) さしす B) かきく C) すべる D) トウ *My answer: _____*
4.	廃	A) すたれる B) かきく C) さしす D) ハイ *My answer: _____*
5.	署	A) さしす B) ショ C) — D) かきく *My answer: _____*

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
6.	訴	A) かきく　B) うったえる　C) さしす　D) ソ *My answer: _____*
7.	議	A) さしす　B) かきく　C) —　D) ギ *My answer: _____*
8.	策	A) サク　B) —　C) かきく　D) さしす *My answer: _____*

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	権	____	A	right/authority
2.	律	____	B	sue/appeal
3.	統	____	C	law/regulation
4.	廃	____	D	govern/unify
5.	署	____	E	abandon/discard
6.	訴	____	F	deliberate
7.	議	____	G	abolish/廃
8.	策	____	H	plan/scheme
9.	棄	____	I	office/sign

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「権」を使った言葉: ___利 *Compound using 権: 権利 (rights)*	
2.	「律」を使った言葉: ___法 *Compound using 律: 法律 (law)*	
3.	「統」を使った言葉: ___一 *Compound using 統: 統一 (unification)*	
4.	「廃」を使った言葉: ___止 *Compound using 廃: 廃止 (abolition)*	
5.	「署」を使った言葉: ___警察 *Compound using 署: 警察署 (police station)*	
6.	「訴」を使った言葉: ___える *Compound using 訴: 訴える (appeal/sue)*	
7.	「議」を使った言葉: ___会 *Compound using 議: 議会 (parliament)*	
8.	「策」を使った言葉: ___政 *Compound using 策: 政策 (policy)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Lesson 8: Appearance, Perception & Description (外見・知覚・描写)

Appearance and perception kanji help you describe things vividly. These are particularly important in N3 reading passages where you must understand how scenes, people, and situations are described.

1 Usage Notes

Key Points for This Lesson

鮮 (azayaka/SEN) = vivid/fresh. 鮮明 (senmei) = vivid/clear; 新鮮 (shinsen) = fresh (food).
輝 (kagayaku/KI) = to shine/sparkle. An important literary kanji used to describe bright things.
漂 (tadayou/HYOO) = to drift/waft. 漂う = to float/waft (smell, fog, feeling). Very literary.
濁 (nigoru/DAKU) = murky/turbid. 濁る = to become cloudy. 濁声 (nigori goe) = hoarse voice.
透 (tooru/TOO) = transparent/pass through. 透明 (toomei) = transparent; 透き通る = to be clear.

2 Kanji Reference Table

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
鮮	ON: セン kun: あざやか	vivid/fresh	17	鮮明 (senmei) vivid・新鮮 (shinsen) fresh・鮮やか (azayaka) vivid/brilliant
輝	ON: キ kun: かがやく	shine/ sparkle	15	輝く (kagayaku) shine・輝き (kagayaki) brilliance・光輝 (kooki) radiance
漂	ON: ヒョウ kun: ただよう	drift/waft	14	漂う (tadayou) drift・漂流 (hyooryuu) drifting・漂白 (hyoohaku) bleaching
濁	ON: ダク kun: にごる・にごす	murky/ turbid	16	濁る (nigoru) muddy・濁流 (dakuryuu) muddy stream・濁点 (dakuten) voiced mark
透	ON: トウ kun: とおる・すく	transparent	10	透明 (toomei) transparent・透き通る (sukitooru) to be clear・浸透 (shintoo) permeation
凝	ON: ギョウ kun: こる・こごる	congeal/ focus	16	凝る (koru) to be absorbed in・凝縮 (gyooshuku) condensation・凝視 (gyooshi) stare
艶	ON: エン kun: つや・なまめかしい	gloss/ charm	19	艶 (tsiya) gloss・艶やか (tsiyayaka) glossy/charming・色艶 (irotsiya) complexion

漢字	Reading(s)	Meaning	画数	Key Compounds
淡	ON: タン kun: あわい	pale/faint	11	淡い (awai) pale/faint・淡水 (tansui) freshwater・冷淡 (reitan) coldness/indifference
凄	ON: セイ kun: すごい・すさまじい	amazing/ terrible	10	凄い (sugoi) amazing・凄まじい (susamajii) terrific・凄惨 (seisan) gruesome

3 Writing Practice

Trace the guide kanji (light in first box), then write from memory in the remaining boxes. Say the reading and meaning aloud with each stroke. Correct stroke order builds muscle memory.

鮮 セン | vivid/fresh | 17 strokes

Compounds: 鮮明 (senmei) vivid・新鮮 (shinsen) fresh・鮮やか (azayaka) vivid/brilliant

鮮				

輝 キ | shine/sparkle | 15 strokes

Compounds: 輝く (kagayaku) shine・輝き (kagayaki) brilliance・光輝 (kooki) radiance

輝				

漂 ヒョウ | drift/waft | 14 strokes

Compounds: 漂う (tadayou) drift・漂流 (hyooryuu) drifting・漂白 (hyoohaku) bleaching

漂				

濁 ダク | murky/turbid | 16 strokes

Compounds: 濁る (nigoru) muddy・濁流 (dakuryuu) muddy stream・濁点 (dakuten) voiced mark

濁				

透 トウ | transparent | 10 strokes

Compounds: 透明 (toomei) transparent・透き通る (sukitooru) to be clear・浸透 (shintoo) permeation

透				

凝 ギョウ | congeal/focus | 16 strokes

Compounds: 凝る (koru) to be absorbed in・凝縮 (gyooshuku) condensation・凝視 (gyooshi) stare

凝				

艶 エン | gloss/charm | 19 strokes

Compounds: 艶 (tsiya) gloss・艶やか (tsiyayaka) glossy/charming・色艶 (irotsiya) complexion

艶				

淡 タン | pale/faint | 11 strokes

Compounds: 淡い (awai) pale/faint・淡水 (tansui) freshwater・冷淡 (reitan) coldness/indifference

淡				

凄 セイ | amazing/terrible | 10 strokes

Compounds: 凄い (sugoi) amazing・凄まじい (susamajii) terrific・凄惨 (seisan) gruesome

凄				

4 Activities

✏️ Activity 1: Reading Quiz — Choose the Correct Reading

Choose the correct reading for each word. Circle A, B, C, or D.

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
1.	鮮	A) セン B) あざやか C) かきく D) さしす *My answer: _____*
2.	輝	A) さしす B) キ C) かがやく D) かきく *My answer: _____*

#	Word	Choose the correct reading (A / B / C / D)
3.	漂	A) ヒョウ B) ただよう C) さしす D) かきく *My answer: _____*
4.	濁	A) かきく B) ダク C) にごる D) さしす *My answer: _____*
5.	透	A) トウ B) かきく C) とおる D) さしす *My answer: _____*
6.	凝	A) さしす B) ギョウ C) こる D) かきく *My answer: _____*
7.	艶	A) かきく B) さしす C) エン D) つや *My answer: _____*
8.	淡	A) さしす B) かきく C) タン D) あわい *My answer: _____*

🔵 Activity 2: Match Kanji to Meaning

Write the matching letter in the blank.

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
1.	鮮	_____	**A**	murky/turbid
2.	輝	_____	**B**	drift/waft
3.	漂	_____	**C**	shine/sparkle
4.	濁	_____	**D**	pale/faint
5.	透	_____	**E**	vivid/fresh
6.	凝	_____	**F**	congeal/focus
7.	艶	_____	**G**	gloss/charm
8.	淡	_____	**H**	amazing/terrible

#	Kanji	Match	Ltr	English Meaning
9.	凄	_____	I	transparent

✍️ Activity 3: Fill in the Compound Word

Write the correct kanji or reading to complete each compound word.

#	Sentence (fill the blank)	Answer
1.	「鮮」を使った言葉: ___明 *Compound using 鮮: 鮮明 (vivid)*	
2.	「輝」を使った言葉: ___く *Compound using 輝: 輝く (shine)*	
3.	「漂」を使った言葉: ___う *Compound using 漂: 漂う (drift)*	
4.	「濁」を使った言葉: ___る *Compound using 濁: 濁る (muddy)*	
5.	「透」を使った言葉: ___明 *Compound using 透: 透明 (transparent)*	
6.	「凝」を使った言葉: ___る *Compound using 凝: 凝る (to be absorbed in)*	
7.	「艶」を使った言葉: ___ *Compound using 艶: 艶 (gloss)*	
8.	「淡」を使った言葉: ___い *Compound using 淡: 淡い (pale/faint)*	

✍️ Activity 4: Use in Context — Write Original Sentences

Choose 4 kanji from this lesson. Write an original Japanese sentence for each.
Underline the target kanji and write its reading (hiragana) above it.

1. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

2. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

---

3. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

4. Kanji: _____ Sentence:

Answer Key

Activities 1 and 2 depend on the random arrangement of options/right-hand column.
Use each lesson's Reference Table to verify readings and meanings.
Below are answers for Activity 3 (Compound Word Fill-in).

Lesson 1: Emotions & Inner Life (感情・内面)

1. 怒 → 怒る (okoru) get angry
2. 恐 → 恐怖 (kyoofu) terror
3. 悔 → 後悔 (kookai) regret
4. 憎 → 憎む (nikumu) hate
5. 恥 → 恥 (haji) shame
6. 慌 → 慌てる (awateru) panic
7. 励 → 励ます (hagemasu) encourage
8. 憧 → 憧れ (akogare) longing

Lesson 2: Society & Human Relations (社会・人間関係)

1. 争 → 戦争 (sensoo) war
2. 批 → 批判 (hihan) criticism
3. 賛 → 賛成 (sansei) agreement
4. 豊 → 豊か (yutaka) wealthy
5. 貧 → 貧しい (mazushii) poor
6. 犯 → 犯罪 (hanzai) crime
7. 罰 → 罰 (batsu) punishment
8. 誠 → 誠実 (seijitsu) sincere

Lesson 3: Nature & Environment (自然・環境)

1. 災 → 災害 (saigai) disaster
2. 燃 → 燃える (moeru) burn
3. 汚 → 汚染 (osen) pollution
4. 乾 → 乾燥 (kansoo) dryness
5. 枯 → 枯れる (kareru) wither
6. 浸 → 浸水 (shinsui) flooding
7. 霧 → 霧 (kiri) fog
8. 稲 → 稲 (ine) rice plant

Lesson 4: Thought, Speech & Communication (思考・言語・伝達)

1. 述 → 述べる (noberu) state
2. 訴 → 訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue
3. 宣 → 宣言 (sengen) declaration
4. 訳 → 翻訳 (hon'yaku) translation
5. 諭 → 諭す (satosu) admonish
6. 唱 → 唱える (tonaeru) chant/advocate
7. 欺 → 欺く (azamuku) deceive
8. 弁 → 弁護士 (bengoshi) lawyer

Lesson 5: Work, Study & Achievement (仕事・学習・達成)

1. 努 → 努力 (doryoku) effort
2. 勤 → 勤務 (kinmu) duty
3. 績 → 成績 (seiseki) grades
4. 奨 → 奨学金 (shoogakukin) scholarship
5. 雇 → 雇用 (koyoo) employment
6. 昇 → 昇進 (shooshin) promotion
7. 免 → 免許 (menkyo) license
8. 携 → 携帯 (keitai) mobile phone/carrying

Lesson 6: Movement, Change & Process (動き・変化・過程)

1. 揺 → 揺れる (yureru) shake
2. 崩 → 崩壊 (hookai) collapse
3. 貫 → 貫く (tsuranuku) pierce/persist
4. 浮 → 浮かぶ (ukabu) float
5. 沈 → 沈む (shizumu) sink
6. 継 → 継続 (keizoku) continuation
7. 超 → 超える (koeru) exceed
8. 跳 → 跳ぶ (tobu) jump

Lesson 7: Government, Law & Power (政治・法律・権力)

1. 権 → 権利 (kenri) rights
2. 律 → 法律 (hooritsu) law
3. 統 → 統一 (tooitsu) unification

4. 廃 → 廃止 (haishi) abolition
5. 署 → 警察署 (keisatsusho) police station
6. 訴 → 訴える (uttaeru) appeal/sue
7. 議 → 議会 (gikai) parliament
8. 策 → 政策 (seisaku) policy

Lesson 8: Appearance, Perception & Description (外見・知覚・描写)

1. 鮮 → 鮮明 (senmei) vivid
2. 輝 → 輝く (kagayaku) shine
3. 漂 → 漂う (tadayou) drift
4. 濁 → 濁る (nigoru) muddy
5. 透 → 透明 (toomei) transparent
6. 凝 → 凝る (koru) to be absorbed in
7. 艶 → 艶 (tsiya) gloss
8. 淡 → 淡い (awai) pale/faint